Rajat Gupta

AVP Engineering | Platform, SRE and Security Leadership

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Summary

Engineering leader with 11+ years in software, DevOps and SRE, the last six leading platform, SRE and security teams. AVP Engineering at the Reserve Bank Innovation Hub (RBIH), a wholly owned subsidiary of the Reserve Bank of India, responsible for platform engineering, reliability, security readiness and AI adoption across financial-sector digital public infrastructure such as the Unified Lending Interface (ULI), MuleHunter.AI and the Digital Payments Intelligence Platform (DPIP). Previously spent more than nine years in Berlin leading SRE, platform and security work at PlayStation, TIDAL and Paymenttools (REWE Digital) across payments, streaming, cloud gaming, e-commerce and energy. Focused on clear ownership, data-backed decisions and processes that reduce noise.

Core Competencies

Leadership: Team leadership and hiring, mentoring, technical strategy, roadmaps, executive and regulator alignment
Reliability: SRE operating models, SLOs, error budgets, incident management, on-call, postmortems, disaster recovery
Platform: Internal developer platforms, CI/CD, GitOps, infrastructure as code, Kubernetes, hybrid and multi-cloud
Security and Compliance: DevSecOps, security audits, vulnerability assessments, DPDP Act readiness, PCI DSS, ISMS
AI in Engineering: AI adoption in engineering, agent-ready platform interfaces, GenAI automation, GPU compute

Experience

Reserve Bank Innovation Hub (RBIH) **Jun 2026 – Present**
AVP Engineering Bengaluru, India

- Lead platform engineering, infrastructure, CI/CD and DevOps across RBIH's platforms as part of the CTO's engineering leadership team, and hire for DevOps and MLOps roles.
- Drive production reliability and incident response for ULI, the credit digital public infrastructure that connects lenders with data service providers through standard APIs.
- Designed RBIH's incident management practice (P0 to P2 severity model, four incident roles, time-bound escalation, on-call rotations, mandatory postmortems for P0 and P1) and lead its rollout, starting with ULI. Chose the tooling through a live trial of three platforms on real production alerts.
- Shape infrastructure, capacity and disaster recovery planning for fraud-prevention platforms MuleHunter.AI and DPIP.
- Drive engineering-side security and compliance readiness, including security audits, vulnerability assessments and Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act obligations.
- Lead AI adoption in engineering, from agent-ready platform interfaces to GPU compute for AI/ML workloads.

Paymenttools (REWE Digital) **May 2025 – May 2026**
Senior Engineering Manager Berlin, Germany

- Led and mentored SRE and Security engineers, focusing on psychological safety, fair processes and growth plans.
- Rolled out SRE practices across 14 product teams: SLOs, change management, on-call and a single incident management framework (severity model for PCI workloads, incident commander roles, post-incident reviews), backed by production readiness reviews.
- Co-designed the data platform that enables real-time analytics on 1.5B+ annual payment transactions.
- Defined the long-term SRE and Security roadmap, delivering a self-service platform with GenAI automation that removes manual toil.
- Led Runbook Runner, a Backstage plugin that turns static runbooks into guided, auditable workflows with confirmations, dry runs and change review for privileged steps, aligned with PCI and ISMS requirements.
- Designed and built Rift, a self-hosted tool that applies declarative code changes across thousands of GitHub repositories and reconciles pull requests until merged, cutting the time to roll out security fixes from weeks to hours.

TIDAL (Block Inc.) **Jun 2022 – Mar 2025**
Engineering Manager Berlin, Germany

- Led a 6-person SRE team owning release, in-production and monitoring strategy, cutting service disruptions by 50%.
- Rolled out an SRE operating model (SLOs, error budgets, service tiers, runbooks, DORA reporting) through training and process changes, improving system reliability by 80% and reducing MTTR by 50%.
- Revamped CI/CD and test automation with Engineering and Product: 8% more uptime, 70% higher user satisfaction.
- Delivered multi-CDN edge compute (Fastly, Cloudflare, CloudFront), cutting CDN costs by 12%.
- Introduced observability governance and cost-per-service reporting in the internal developer portal, cutting log spend by 30% and total observability cost by 12%.
- Replaced the deprecated AWS App Mesh with Consul service discovery across ECS and EC2, with mTLS on by default.

PlayStation (Sony Interactive Entertainment) **Feb 2020 – May 2022**
Site Reliability Engineer, PlayStation Now Berlin, Germany

- Led the Platform Automation team, automating hardware bring-up across 20+ data centers so new racks reached production in hours instead of days, and cutting manual operational work by 40%.
- Kept the cloud gaming service at 99.99% uptime on hybrid infrastructure across AWS and 20+ data centers.
- Built a Prometheus and Grafana observability platform ingesting 300+ GB of metrics per day from 100K+ servers, with self-service APIs for dashboards, alerts and synthetic tests. Downtime incidents fell by 30%.

Private Sale GmbH (eBay) **Aug 2019 – Jan 2020**
Senior DevOps Engineer Berlin, Germany

- Migrated critical services from on-prem data centers to GCP, reducing infrastructure spend by 15%.
- Designed CI/CD pipelines for hybrid deployments, halving release times, and tuned load balancing and caching to cut latency by 20%.

Entelios (Agder Energi) **Dec 2017 – Jul 2019**
Senior DevOps Engineer Berlin, Germany

- Ran the distributed systems behind real-time energy trading, and built the infrastructure to operate 200+ hydropower plants remotely.
- Migrated and tuned services to sustain 100% availability across multiple data centers.

SuitePad GmbH **Feb 2017 – Nov 2017**
DevOps Engineer Berlin, Germany

- Designed the microservice architecture, process and data flows for a hospitality platform, and ran its AWS workloads at 99.99% uptime with auto-scaling and secure delivery pipelines.

ThoughtWorks **Jul 2015 – Jan 2017**
Application Developer Bengaluru, India

- Built web and mobile applications with highly available infrastructure and zero-downtime releases, and delivered ML, big data and microservice projects while refining requirements directly with clients.

Openlabs Technologies **Jan 2015 – Apr 2015**
Software Developer Noida, India

- Built ERP systems and web applications on open-source technologies for large e-commerce clients.

Writing, Speaking and Community

- Write about SRE, security, platform engineering and leadership at rajatgupta.work and Engineering Pulse. Recent posts: *GitOps: Beyond the Hype* (2026), *Terraform at Scale: Patterns and Anti-Patterns* (2026), *The Three Pillars of Observability* (2026), *Proving the ROI of Your SRE Program* (2025), *Threat Modeling: The Ultimate Guide* (2025).
- Speaker on observability, incident management and platform reliability at industry and community events.
- Mentored 20+ engineers on SRE practices, platform engineering and leadership. Open-source contributor on GitHub.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, Go, Java, Bash, SQL
Cloud: AWS (ECS, EC2, Lambda, S3, CloudFront, Secrets Manager), GCP (Compute, Storage, Spanner)
Containers and GitOps: Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, FluxCD, ArgoCD, Istio, Consul
IaC and CI/CD: Terraform, Ansible, Packer, CloudFormation, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, GitLab CI
Observability and Incidents: Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager, Datadog, ELK, CloudWatch, PagerDuty, incident.io
Security: HashiCorp Vault, AWS Secrets Manager, mTLS, zero trust networking, security scanning
Edge and Data: Fastly, Cloudflare, CloudFront, Spanner, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, DynamoDB
Developer Platforms: Backstage, internal developer portals, FastAPI, GenAI automation